

MSP Access & Cash-Bridge Platform

Helping Indian farmers sell at MSP faster and fairly,
and get paid on time

MARKET	India (all states; pilot in one district)
STAGE	Idea / initial project, aiming to scale into a startup
PREPARED	4 October 2026 (updated with founder field observations)
PREPARED BY	Claude, AI startup advisor (desk research and analysis)

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How to read this report

Scores are out of 10: green is 7 or above, amber 5 to 6.9, red below 5. Every number is either **sourced** (public data) or an **assumption** (our estimate), and says which. Pain points are tagged **Sourced**, **Founder observed** (first-hand account from the founder, one source so far) or **Hypothesis** (untested). Your farmer interviews in Week 1 must confirm or kill the last two groups.

What your field input changed since the first draft

1) **Cash timing** is now treated as a core problem: you observed about one month between sale and government payment, which pushes farmers to sell locally. 2) **Slot bribery** (money asked per quintal to move a turn) is now a first-hand observation, not just a hypothesis. 3) **Quantity limits** are verified: states can buy only a share of production and set per-farmer caps, so MSP can never cover the whole crop. 4) The product is reframed from 'sell directly to the government' to **access, transparency and a cash bridge**. 5) Overall score rose from 5.4 to **5.8**; the verdict stays Conditional Go.

1. Executive Summary

Idea	A platform that helps Indian farmers get the MSP they are eligible for with less waiting and no middlemen, and bridges the cash gap until government payment arrives
Founder insight	Son of a farmer; has personally seen farmers forced to sell locally for quick cash, and has seen and heard of money being asked to move a slot
Stage and mode	Idea stage. Start as a project (30-day validation); scale into a startup only if the gates in Section 14 are met
Overall score	5.8 / 10 (real, sharper problem; unproven demand; revenue path now clearer)
Verdict	CONDITIONAL GO: proceed as a time-boxed validation project, not yet as a funded company

The one thing to change in your framing

The government **already** buys directly from farmers at MSP through FCI, NAFED and state agencies, and some states run online registration and slot booking (for example MP e-Uparjan). A private startup cannot become the buyer, and the government does not buy the whole crop. The real opportunity is the **farmer-side layer**: tell each farmer what quantity they can sell, get them registered and into a visible queue, let them report slot demands safely, track their payment, and connect them through partner lenders to early cash so they are not forced to sell cheap.

Key findings

- **Coverage is low.** About 15% of paddy sellers and 9.6% of wheat sellers sell into MSP procurement (4.5% to 10.5% for marginal farmers). One 2026 source puts MSP reach at 13 to 14% of farming families. Yet 1.84 crore farmers already benefit, so the user base exists.
- **MSP has hard limits.** For pulses, oilseeds and copra a state can initially buy up to 25% of its production (100% for tur, urad and masur), and states set per-farmer caps. Whatever the platform does, part of every crop must be sold elsewhere.
- **Cash timing drives behaviour.** The founder's observation is about a month from sale to payment; official reports say 24 to 48 hours in major procuring states. The gap between the two is the single most important number to measure.
- **Slot payments make queue position valuable.** If quotas can run out, a late slot can mean no MSP at all. A visible queue and a safe reporting route would be a rare, defensible feature.
- **The 'middleman' also lends.** In Punjab, commission agents handle cleaning, weighing, loading and often credit; many farmers kept using them after direct payment began. A cash bridge replaces their most important function.
- **Weak spots:** farmers rarely pay for apps, lending is regulated, and there are no structured interviews yet (evidence 3/10).
- **Timing is good.** Kharif procurement runs around now (confirm your state's dates), so you can test with real farmers within weeks.

Dimension	Score	Dimension	Score
Problem severity and breadth	9/10	Monetisation clarity	4/10
Founder-market fit	6/10	MVP feasibility	7/10
Market size (revenue pool)	5/10	Evidence gathered so far	3/10
Competitive white space	6/10	Weighted overall	5.8/10

2. Problem Validation

Founder's problem statement: farmers wait days for their turn to sell, losing work at home; staff and intermediaries use malpractices (including money for slots); farmers cannot wait a month for payment, so they sell locally; and a fixed quantity limit means they cannot sell more to the government.

Sharpened statement: *Small and marginal farmers need cash quickly and a fair place in the queue, but MSP selling is slow, capped, opaque and paid late, so many sell locally below MSP.*

Evidence from public sources and the founder

Evidence	Source	What it means for you
Only 15% of paddy and 9.6% of wheat sellers sell into MSP procurement; marginal farmers 10.5% and 4.5%. Large farmers capture more.	Business Standard on a state-run institute paper (Mar 2025)	The underserved majority is small and marginal farmers.
Only 13 to 14% of farming families get MSP benefit through procurement. Earlier estimates: about 6% (2015) and 13 to 16% of rice and wheat sellers.	IMPRI summary citing India Today (2026); Shanta Kumar Committee; RAS	Estimates differ, but all show low reach.
2024-25 procurement: 1,223 LMT worth ₹3.47 lakh crore, benefiting 1.84 crore farmers.	IMPRI, citing Ministry of Agriculture (2025)	Large money flow and a big existing user base.
Wheat 2025-26: 21.03 lakh farmers benefited by 1 May 2026; payment in most cases within 24 to 48 hours.	ANI via The Tribune	Official claim. Conflicts with the founder's one-month observation; measure it.
Founder observed: about one month between sale and government payment; farmers need cash for current costs and next season's crop, so they sell to local markets.	Founder, first-hand	Possible core driver. Confirm days, crop, state and agency in interviews.
Founder observed: staff ask for money per quintal to move a farmer's turn forward while others keep waiting.	Founder, first-hand and heard	One source so far. Needs about 10 independent accounts across centres.
States can buy up to 25% of state production of pulses, oilseeds and copra at first (100% for tur, urad, masur); more needs approval.	PM-AASHA explainers (2026)	Confirms a limit exists; MSP can never cover the whole crop.
Gujarat summer moong 2025-26: purchase based on sown area at 1,200 kg per hectare, capped at 1,500 kg per farmer.	NewKerala (state announcement)	Per-farmer caps are real. An eligible-quantity calculator has value.
MP farmers protested for 100% summer moong procurement as prices slumped; Centre said more approval only after existing quota is used.	Business Standard (Jul 2026)	Quotas can run out, which raises the value of queue position.
Wheat procurement is concentrated: Punjab 103.89, MP 67.57, Haryana 65.67, Rajasthan 11.44, UP 7.55 (lakh tonnes).	ANI via The Tribune	White space in states with many farmers and little procurement.
Punjab farmers kept preferring arhtiyas for payments after direct transfer; arhtiyas handle cleaning, weighing, loading.	The Tribune; GKToday	Intermediaries provide real services, including credit.

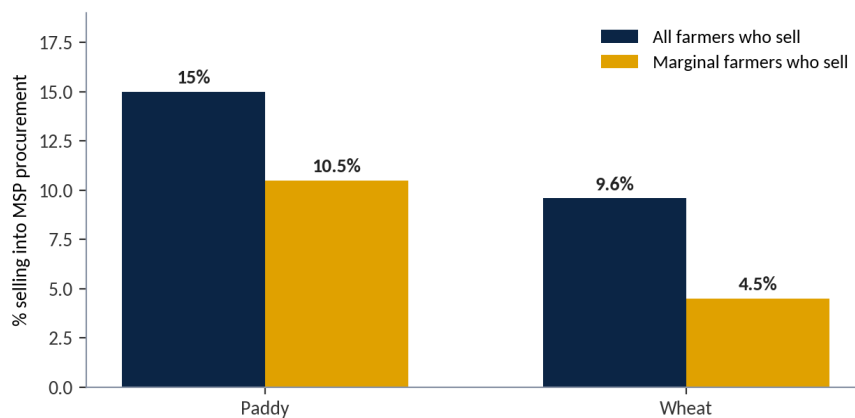


Figure 1. Share of farmers who sell into MSP procurement. Source: Business Standard report on a state-run institute paper (2025).

Problem scorecard

Criterion	Score	Rationale
Severity	9/10	Late cash, caps, rejections and slot demands hit income directly and force below-MSP sales.
Breadth	8/10	14.6 crore holdings, 86% small or marginal; most do not use MSP procurement.
Frequency	6/10	Acute but seasonal: two main windows a year (rabi and kharif).
Gap in current solutions	7/10	Portals cover registration in some states; none cover cash timing, quota visibility or safe reporting.
Willingness to pay	4/10	Farmers are cost-sensitive; a lender or partner is the likelier payer.
Evidence quality	5/10	Rules verified and first-hand founder observations, but no structured interviews.
Problem validation score	6.5/10	Real and sharper than before; demand for a paid solution still unproven.

Handling the slot-payment finding

Treat your observation as a strong lead. When you interview, ask each farmer neutrally what happened to them (date, centre, what was asked, what they did). Record patterns by centre and week, **not names**. Do not confront staff, and never help anyone pay. Serious cases belong with the official helpline or vigilance channel for that state. This protects you, the farmers and the credibility of any later data.

3. Founder-Market Fit Score

Based on what you told us: son of a farmer, first-hand observation of both the cash squeeze and the slot problem, a student who builds with AI and code, and a strong personal mission. Anything not stated is scored conservatively.

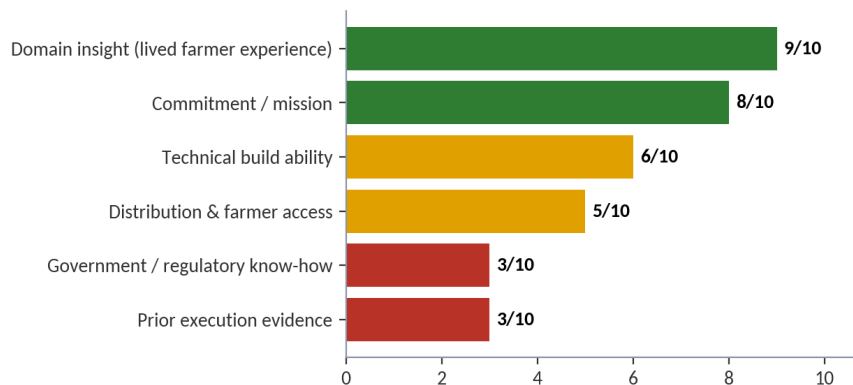


Figure 2. Founder-market fit by criterion.

Criterion	Weight	Score	Comment
Domain insight	25%	9/10	You have seen the cash squeeze and the slot problem yourself; rare and valuable for trust.
Technical build ability	20%	6/10	You can build the information layer yourself; lending needs partners.
Distribution and farmer access	20%	5/10	Family and village network is a start. You need an FPO, CSC or district link.
Government and regulatory know-how	15%	3/10	Procurement, caps and credit rules are specialised; find an advisor.
Commitment and mission	10%	8/10	Strong personal motivation.
Prior execution evidence	10%	3/10	Nothing shipped or tested yet.
Weighted founder-market fit		6/10	Moderate to strong. Domain edge is clear; distribution and regulatory know-how are the gaps.

How to close the gaps

Find one advisor who knows procurement or farm credit (a retired agriculture officer, FPO leader, cooperative bank staff or CSC operator). Ship a small pilot to build execution evidence. Both fit inside the 30-day plan.

4. TAM, SAM and SOM Analysis

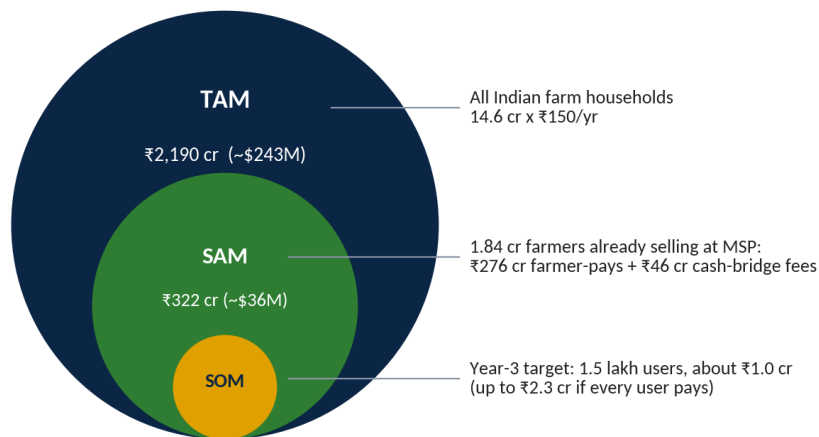


Figure 3. Market sizing (revenue pool for a farmer-facing service). ₹90 per US\$ used for conversion. All price points are assumptions.

Layer	Definition	Calculation	Size
TAM	All Indian farm households that could use an MSP-access service	14.6 crore holdings (Agriculture Census 2015-16) x ₹150 a year (assumption)	₹2,190 crore (~\$243M)
SAM	Farmers who already sell into MSP procurement, plus the cash-bridge fees from those who want early cash	1.84 crore x ₹150 = ₹276 crore; plus 10% taking a bridge x ₹250 partner fee = ₹46 crore (assumptions)	₹322 crore (~\$36M)
SOM (year 3)	Realistic capture from a bootstrapped start	1.5 lakh users: 20% pay ₹150 = ₹45 lakh; 10% bridged x ₹250 = ₹37.5 lakh; 20 FPO or agency pilots x ₹1 lakh = ₹20 lakh	About ₹1.0 crore (~\$0.11M); up to ₹2.3 crore if all pay

Why the cash bridge matters commercially (illustration)

A farmer selling 20 quintals of wheat at the 2026-27 MSP of ₹2,585 is owed ₹51,700. If a partner lender advances 80% (₹41,360) for 30 days at an assumed 1.25% a month, the financing cost is about ₹517. A platform fee of about ₹250 per bridged farmer is plausible, but lending rates, partner terms and rules must be confirmed with a regulated lender. Across the 1.84 crore farmers who sold at MSP, even a small share is a meaningful partner-paid pool.

What this tells you

- **As a pure farmer-pays app this is a small business.** The year-3 figure is closer to ₹1 crore than ₹2 crore once you admit that not every user pays.
- **Venture scale needs partners as payers:** lenders, FPOs, state agencies, input and grain companies that want verified, on-time farmers.
- **The ₹150 and ₹250 figures are assumptions.** Test both in the Week 3 pilot.
- **Context:** India's agritech market is sized at about \$974M in 2025 by one source and about \$9B by another using a broader definition. Pure-play agritech funding was about \$202M in 2025, roughly 76% below the 2022 peak, so investors want clear unit economics.

5. Competitor Analysis

Player	Type	What they do	Scale (public data)	Threat
State procurement portals (e.g. MP e-Uparjan)	Government	Farmer registration, slot booking, crop purchase tracking, direct payment	Whole-state coverage; free to farmers	High
NAFED e-Samridhi	Government cooperative	Aadhaar-based pre-registration to sell pulses and oilseeds at MSP; helpline 1800 210 1222	National, crop-specific	Medium
e-NAM	Government	Online mandi trading with direct payment; not MSP procurement itself	1,656 mandis; 1.80 crore farmers; 2.73 lakh traders	Medium
DeHaat	Private agritech	Inputs, advisory, credit facilitation, market linkage through local centres	1.8M+ farmers; 12 states; 11,000+ centres; \$270M+ raised	High
Arya.ag	Private agritech	Post-harvest grain storage and finance	₹725 crore Series D (Jan 2026)	High
Samunnati and other agri-lenders	Agri-fintech	Lending to farmers and producer groups	Reported profitable; scale varies	Medium
Ninjacart	Private agritech	B2B fresh-produce supply chain	1M+ farmers; large funding	Low
Arhtiyas / commission agents	Informal incumbent	Handling, weighing, loading and cash or credit at mandis	About 28,000 registered in Punjab alone	High
CSCs and cyber cafes	Informal	Paid help with registration and forms (field observation; verify)	Very high local reach	Medium

Threat ratings are our judgement. With the cash bridge in scope, Arya.ag and DeHaat move up, because both already combine grain, credit and farmer trust. The arhtiya remains the most dangerous incumbent because he provides cash and certainty today.

6. Market Gap Analysis

Farmer need	Govt portals	Agri-tech apps	Arhtiyas / agents	Your concept
One guided flow across states and crops	Weak	Weak	Weak	Strong
Know eligible quantity and quota left before travelling	Weak	Weak	Weak	Strong
Local language, voice and WhatsApp-first support	Weak	Moderate	Strong	Strong
Slot and queue transparency; safe reporting of slot demands	Weak	Weak	Weak	Strong
Payment tracking and grievance escalation	Weak	Weak	Weak	Strong
Cash within days of sale	Weak	Moderate	Strong	Moderate
Handling, weighing and logistics	Weak	Moderate	Strong	Weak

Ratings show how well each option serves the need today (our assessment). Nobody owns the **guidance, queue transparency and payment tracking** layer for the small farmer. Cash is where arhtiyas win, so your concept must reach it through partners, not by lending directly.

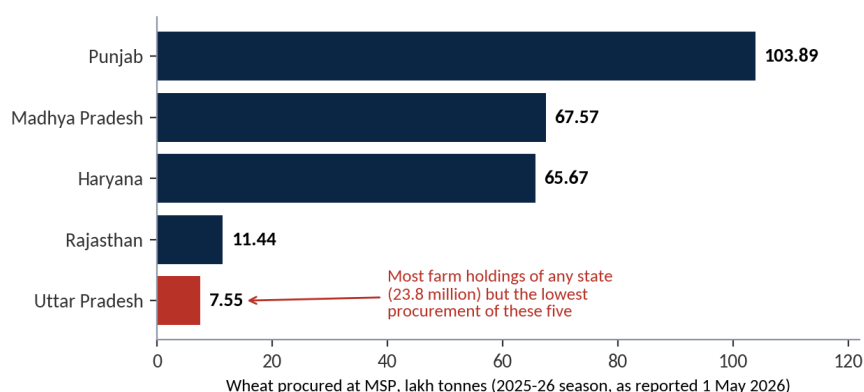


Figure 4. Wheat procured at MSP by state, 2025-26. Source: ANI via The Tribune (as of 1 May 2026).

Product concept (version 2) and revenue model

Layer	Features	Who pays	Build effort	Phase
1. Access guide	Eligibility and document check; eligible-quantity calculator (area x productivity norm, capped); centre finder; slot guidance and reminders	Free at first; later FPOs or CSCs	Low	1 (project)
2. Transparency	Quota-left tracker; queue visibility where data exists; anonymous reports of slot demands by centre and week; payment tracker with nudge when overdue	State agencies, FPOs, grants	Medium	1 to 2
3. Cash bridge	Match verified farmers with partner lenders for advances against a procurement receipt or stored grain; plan the split sale of surplus	Lender or partner (lead or servicing fee)	High	2 to 3

You do not lend, hold farmers' money or store Aadhaar or bank numbers. Partners do the regulated parts.

7. Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Attribute	Beachhead ICP
Who	Small and marginal farmers (under 2 hectares) who grow an MSP-procured crop and depend on quick cash after harvest
Crops (start with one)	Wheat in rabi or paddy in kharif; pulses and oilseeds (where caps and quotas bite hardest) as the second step
Location	One district you know, in a state with a working portal and low participation (UP, Bihar, MP or Rajasthan are candidates; choose your home area)
Distance to centre	Within about 50 km of a procurement centre, so a slot actually helps
Money situation	Needs cash within days for household costs, labour, loan instalments or next-season seed and fertiliser
Digital readiness	Owns an Android phone, uses WhatsApp, has an Aadhaar-linked bank account
Current behaviour	Sells to a local trader or agent for quick cash, or tried a centre and was delayed or turned away
Reachable through	FPOs, CSCs, village WhatsApp groups, gram panchayat, local input shops, cooperative bank branches
Exclude for now	Large farmers (already well served), perishables, states without a working procurement portal

Beachhead segment scoring

Segment	Pain	Reach	Ease of pilot	Total /30
Small wheat farmers in a low-procurement district	8/10	7/10	8/10	23/30
FPO members (collective selling)	7/10	8/10	7/10	22/30
Pulses and oilseed farmers (caps and quotas)	9/10	6/10	6/10	21/30
Paddy farmers in Bihar, Bengal or eastern UP	9/10	5/10	5/10	19/30

Scores are our judgement; replace them with your interview findings.

8. Buyer Persona

Illustrative personas built from desk research and your observations. Rebuild them from interviews in Week 2.

	Persona A: the farmer (user)	Persona B: the partner (payer)
Name and role	Ramesh, 38 , small farmer, 1.5 ha, wheat or paddy, loan instalment due	Sunita, 41 , FPO manager, cooperative bank officer or district procurement officer
Goals	Sell at MSP if it is quick; have cash for next season; lose as few working days as possible	More verified members, fewer disputes, healthier repayments, clean numbers for her report
Frustrations	Month-long wait for payment; capped quantity; unclear documents; queue and rumours of money for slots; rejection for moisture	Farmers arrive unprepared; rejections cause conflict; no data on where delays occur; default risk on advances
Tech and trust	Android and WhatsApp, Hindi or local language; trusts neighbours and his local agent	Email and government portals; cautious about data and vendors
How they decide	Family, a neighbour who already sold, the local agent, FPO leader	Pilot results, written approval, peer reference from another district
Reach them via	WhatsApp groups, FPO meetings, CSC, village influencers	Direct meetings, incubator introductions, government innovation programmes

9. Customer Pain Points

#	Pain point	Severity	Evidence status
1	Government payment reported at about a month; farmers sell locally to get cash for ongoing costs and the next crop	High	Founder observed
2	Money reportedly asked per quintal to move a turn forward while others wait	High	Founder observed
3	Long wait and queues at procurement centres; lost working days	High	Sourced
4	Per-farmer quantity caps and state quotas: only part of the crop can go to MSP, and quota can run out	High	Sourced
5	Not knowing which documents, registration steps or slot rules apply	High	Partly sourced
6	Pressure from traders to sell below MSP at the farm gate	High	Partly sourced
7	Rejection for quality (moisture, impurities) after travelling	High	Hypothesis
8	No trusted way to see slot status, quota left or payment status	Medium	Hypothesis
9	Dependence on agents and cyber cafes for forms, with fees	Medium	Hypothesis
10	Aadhaar, bank and land-record mismatches block registration or payment	Medium	Hypothesis

Evidence key: Sourced = public source; Partly sourced = indirect; Founder observed = first-hand account, one source so far; Hypothesis = untested.

10. Buying Triggers and Objections

Triggers

Trigger	Why it works	How to use it
Start of a procurement season and the announced MSP	Farmers are deciding where to sell	Launch the checklist and eligible-quantity calculator before harvest
Cash needed now (loan instalment, labour, seed for next crop)	The pain is immediate and personal	Show bridge options next to the MSP payment date
Quota or token window about to close	Fear of missing out on MSP	Quota-left alerts and nearest-centre suggestions
Payment overdue	Anxiety and anger are high	Payment tracker with escalation to the official helpline
A neighbour sold successfully at MSP	Social proof is the strongest local signal	Referral inside village WhatsApp groups
Market price drops below MSP, or state bonus (e.g. MP wheat ₹2,585 plus ₹40 in 2026-27)	The cost of not using MSP becomes visible	Show the total expected amount in rupees

Objections and responses

Objection	Response
'I need cash now. The government pays late.'	Offer the bridge through a partner lender. Compare total cost and net price against a below-MSP local sale.
'My agent gives me cash and credit.'	Do not fight this in Phase 1. Show options side by side and let the farmer choose.
'If I complain about the slot, I will lose my turn.'	Anonymous reporting; aggregate by centre and week; no names; never required to confront staff.
'I do not trust apps with my Aadhaar and bank details.'	Do not store them. Guide to the official portal. State the privacy promise clearly.
'The government portal is free. Why use you?'	Free is not the same as easy. Offer local-language voice help, reminders, quota alerts and escalation. Free at first.
'Is this a government site?'	State plainly that you are an independent helper. Never imply official status.

11. Customer Journey

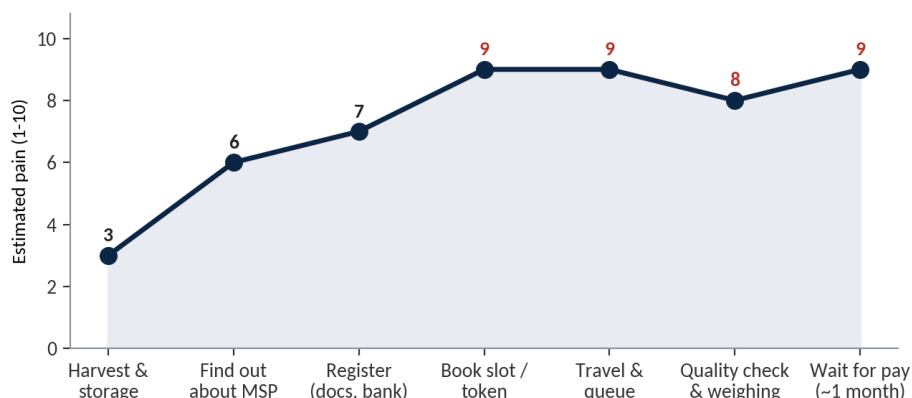


Figure 5. Estimated pain along the MSP selling journey (hypothesis, to be validated). Peaks: slot booking, queue, and the wait for payment.

Stage	What the farmer does	Friction	Product opportunity
Harvest and storage	Dries, cleans, stores grain	Moisture and quality risk	Pre-trip quality checklist
Find out about MSP	Hears from neighbours, agents, news	Rumour-based information; unclear eligible quantity	Season alerts; eligible-quantity calculator

Stage	What the farmer does	Friction	Product opportunity
Register	Documents, bank link, portal or CSC	Wrong documents, record mismatch, fees	Document checker; CSC or family mode
Book slot or token	Selects a date at a centre	No slots, unclear rules, reported money for turns	Guided booking, reminders, quota-left alerts, anonymous reporting
Travel and queue	Brings the lot to the centre	Days of waiting, uncertainty	Queue status where partner data exists
Quality check and weighing	Lot inspected and weighed	Rejection, disputes, possible malpractice	Record the reason; escalate to the helpline
Wait for payment	Waits for bank credit; needs cash meanwhile	About a month (founder observation); sells locally instead	Payment tracker; partner cash bridge; split-sale plan for surplus

12. Risk Assessment

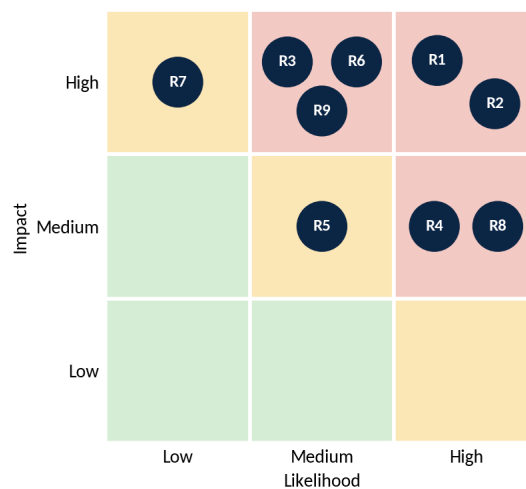


Figure 6. Risk heat map. R-numbers match the register below.

ID	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
R1	Platform dependency: no public APIs; portal rules change each season	High	High	Guide, do not scrape or log in for farmers; partner with agencies; track rule changes
R2	Monetisation: farmers unwilling to pay; government pays slowly	High	High	Start free; find a paying partner (lender, FPO, CSC, agency) early
R3	Trust and adoption: farmers trust agents and neighbours more than apps	Medium	High	Launch through trusted local people; voice-first design
R4	Seasonality: two windows a year, thin usage off-season	High	Medium	Add year-round features such as price alerts and scheme reminders
R5	Data privacy and compliance (Aadhaar, bank and land data; DPDP Act 2023)	Medium	Medium	Collect minimum data; no Aadhaar or bank numbers; get legal advice before scale
R6	Safety and retaliation: reporting slot demands can anger staff or agents; defamation risk if individuals are named	Medium	High	Anonymous, aggregate reporting; no names; route serious cases to official channels; take legal advice
R7	Incumbent response (DeHaat, Arya.ag or government adds similar features)	Low	High	Build local trust and data advantage fast; be a partner
R8	Founder bandwidth as a student	High	Medium	Time-boxed sprints; find an advisor or co-founder
R9	Credit risk and regulation: lending is regulated; partner or default problems	Medium	High	Never lend or hold funds; use regulated partners; keep the bridge for Phase 2 or later

13. Pivot Opportunities

If farmer interviews show weak demand, or farmers will not pay, these adjacent options are ranked by our judgement. P1 and P4 are also natural extensions of the core idea.

Pivot	Idea	Why it could work	Attractiveness	Effort
P1	Cash bridge with lender partners: advances against a procurement receipt or stored grain	Solves the main reason farmers sell cheap; a lender can pay for verified farmers	8/10	High
P2	B2G transparency SaaS: queue, quota and grievance analytics for procurement agencies	Agencies have budgets and the problem; venture-scale revenue pool	7/10	High
P3	FPO toolkit: collective registration, aggregation, bulk slots	4,724 FPOs are on e-NAM; they gain from group selling	7/10	Medium
P4	Eligible-quantity and quota tracker over WhatsApp, SMS and IVR	Low cost, fast to test, reaches many farmers	7/10	Low
P5	Post-harvest bridge: storage, warehouse receipts and pledge finance with partners	Fixes cash-at-harvest and the surplus beyond the MSP cap	6/10	High
P6	Open civic-tech project funded by grants and CSR	Fits a mission-first founder; lower revenue pressure	6/10	Low
P7	Mandi billing software for commission agents	Tools already exist; crowded	4/10	Medium

14. Go / No-Go Recommendation

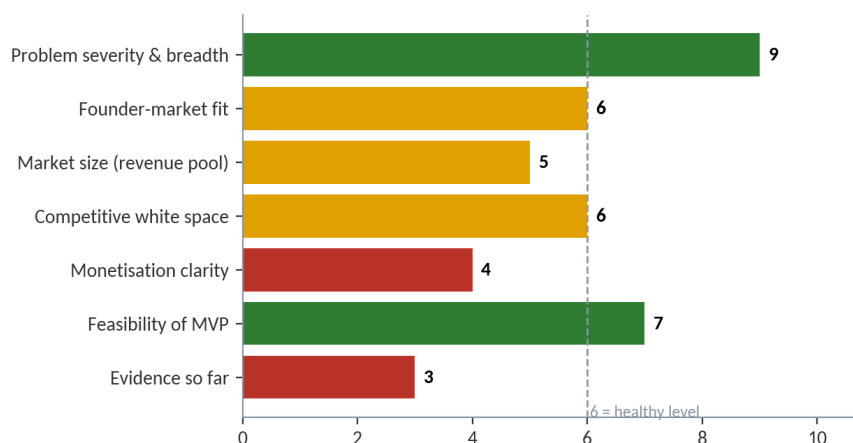


Figure 7. Weighted scorecard. Dashed line marks a healthy level (6).

Dimension	Weight	Score	Weighted
Problem severity and breadth	20%	9/10	1.80
Founder-market fit	15%	6/10	0.90
Market size (revenue pool)	15%	5/10	0.75
Competitive white space	10%	6/10	0.60
Monetisation clarity	15%	4/10	0.60
MVP feasibility	10%	7/10	0.70
Evidence gathered so far	15%	3/10	0.45
Overall	100%	5.8/10	5.80

Decision rule: 7.0 or above is Go; 5.0 to 6.9 is Conditional Go; below 5.0 is No-Go. Score movement from the first draft: 5.4 to 5.8.

Recommendation: CONDITIONAL GO

Proceed as a **30-day, time-boxed validation project** that starts with the access guide (Layer 1). Do not incorporate, raise money, handle farmers' money, or build a direct-to-government channel yet. Re-score at Day 30 against the five gates below.

Gate	Pass condition at Day 30	If it fails
1. Problem	At least 60% of 30+ interviewees describe losing 2 or more days, a rejection, a below-MSP sale or a quantity-limit problem last season	Re-pick segment or crop
2. Cash and slots	Sale-to-payment days recorded for 20+ farmers (note crop, state and agency); at least 10 independent accounts of slot demands across 3+ centres	If payment is under 5 days, drop the bridge; if no slot accounts, drop reporting
3. Solution	At least 40% of 50 to 100 pilot farmers complete a real task (eligibility check, registration help or slot booking) with your tool	Fix the flow or switch channel (CSC or FPO)
4. Value	At least 20% would pay ₹50 to ₹100 a season, or one lender, FPO, CSC or agency agrees to a paid pilot or signs an LOI	Move to a partner-pays model (P1, P2 or P3)
5. Feasibility	You can deliver without breaking portal terms, holding money or storing sensitive IDs	Narrow to information and reminders only

4 or 5 gates pass: move to Phase 2 and pursue incubator, grant or lender partnerships. **3 pass:** iterate another 30 days. **2 or fewer:** pivot using Section 13.

15. 30-Day Action Plan

Days are counted from 5 October 2026. Kharif procurement is under way in many states, so a live pilot is possible. Check your state's notified dates and quantity limits.

Week	Actions	Deliverable	Success metric
1 (Days 1 to 7) Discover	Run 30 structured interviews: 20 small or marginal farmers, 5 FPO or CSC operators, 5 traders, agents or centre staff. For each seller record crop, state, agency, quantity sold, per-farmer limit, days from sale to payment, and what they did for cash. Ask neutrally about slot demands and note centre and week, not names. Visit one centre; note wait times.	Interview log; payment-days table; process map	30 interviews; 20 payment-time data points
2 (Days 8 to 14) Define	Cluster the pains. Choose one crop, one state, one district. Find the official per-farmer limit and quota rules for that crop. Pick the first job to solve (for example: tell me my eligible quantity, check my documents and book a slot). Draft the local-language flow. Write the privacy and 'not a government site' wording.	One-page problem and value statement; rebuilt personas	Top 3 pains ranked by frequency
3 (Days 15 to 21) Pilot	Build a WhatsApp or simple web MVP: eligible-quantity calculator, document checklist, centre info, slot guidance, reminders. Recruit 50 to 100 farmers via family, FPO or CSC. Collect no Aadhaar or bank numbers and hold no money. Test a ₹50 to ₹100 price ask. Open talks with one regulated lender or cooperative bank about a bridge.	Working pilot; usage log; first lender conversation	40% of pilot users complete a task
4 (Days 22 to 30) Decide	Measure completion, time saved, satisfaction and willingness to pay. Hold 2 partner talks (an FPO and a CSC or district agriculture office). Write a 1-page results memo and score the five gates. Apply to an agri-business incubator or startup programme if you pass.	Results memo; Go / No-Go decision	Gates 1 to 5 scored

Interview questions to start with

- Last season, where and how did you sell your crop, and at what price per quintal?
- Did you try to sell at a government centre? What happened, step by step, and how many days did it take?
- How many days passed between the sale and the money reaching your account? What did you do for cash in that time?

- Was there a limit on how much you could sell to the government? What did you do with the rest?
- Did anyone ask you for money or favours to change your turn or slot? (Ask what happened, not who.)
- Was your grain ever rejected or paid less than expected? What reason was given?
- Would you use a free WhatsApp helper for this? Would you pay a small amount in a good season?

Appendix: Sources, assumptions and limitations

Sources used: PIB (MSP procurement and farmer benefit data); ANI via The Tribune (wheat procurement 2025-26); Business Standard (MSP participation study, 2025; MP summer moong quota dispute, 2026); IMPRI summary of PM-AASHA (2024-25 procurement value and farmer count; 13 to 14% reach citing India Today); PM-AASHA explainers from PW.live, Organiser and Affirstap (25% and 100% rules; price-gap payment); NewKerala (Gujarat summer moong per-farmer cap); The Statesman and Shanta Kumar Committee citation; RAS analysis; MP e-Uparjan guides; NAFED e-Samridhi site; e-NAM government statement (April 2026); Agriculture Census 2015-16 summaries; Decentro, Tracxn, Digital in Asia and Inc42-cited agritech figures; The Tribune and GKToday on arhtiyas; Khetivyapar on the MP wheat bonus.

Founder observations: about one month to receive government payment; money asked to move slots; fixed quantity limits. These are first-hand, one source, crop and state not yet specified. **Assumptions:** ₹150 a year per farmer, ₹250 per bridged farmer, 10% bridge take-up, 1.25% monthly financing cost, ₹90 per US\$, and all scores are our judgement. **Limitations:** no structured farmer research; several figures come from secondary websites; Agriculture Census data is from 2015-16 and counts operational holdings, not exactly farmers; per-farmer limits and payment times vary by state, crop and season. This report is advisory and not legal or financial advice.